

WEATHER
Rain this afternoon and colder tonight. Lowest temperature above freezing

The Alexandria Gazette

ESTABLISHED 1784
Oldest Daily Newspaper in the United States and Best Advertising Medium in Northern Virginia.

VOL. CXXXIX—No. 71

The Gateway to the South

ALEXANDRIA, VA., FRIDAY, MARCH 23, 1923.

The Gateway to the South

PRICE TWO CENTS.

REFERENDUM PLAN PASSES ASSEMBLY

\$50,000,000 BOND ISSUE TO BE PUT BEFORE STATE; HOUSE CONCURS TODAY

House Passes Three-Cent Gas Tax; Adjournment Today or Tomorrow

By L. E. COOPER.
Richmond, Va., March 23.—The people of Virginia will be allowed to vote on whether or not they favor a \$50,000,000 bond issue for roads, according to a compromise referendum bill effected by the bond and anti-bond forces passed by the Senate late yesterday and the House of Delegates shortly before two o'clock this afternoon. The Senate polled but one dissenting vote while the house vote was 87 to 4.

The lower body, late yesterday concurred by a vote of 77 to 12 in the Senate amendment to the 3-cent gasoline tax, and with the highway legislation thus in final stages, adjournment of both bodies is expected today or early tomorrow.

The referendum bill as agreed upon calls for a definite vote either for or against bonds, the vote to be cast at the November election. The result will be communicated by the Governor, in the state at large, and then by legislative districts.

The text of the bill is as follows:

1. Be it enacted by the general assembly, of Virginia, that the following questions, as set out in paragraphs A, B, C, D, E, and F, of this Act be, and it is hereby submitted to the qualified voters of the State and the counties and cities thereof as hereinafter provided, for their approval or rejection, to-wit:

(A) Shall General Assembly of nineteen hundred and twenty-four enact legislation directing state bond issues of fifty million dollars.

(B) Fifty per cent of the proceeds of said bond issues to be devoted to the construction of roads and bridges embraced in the State Highway System.

(C) Twenty per cent of the proceeds of said bond issues to be devoted to the construction of roads and bridges embraced in the several county highway systems, provided such roads shall be tributary to and constructed from State highways and provided further that, before said roads are constructed, the same shall be selected by and added to the State Highway System by the State Highway Commission, in addition to roads added to said system, according to other laws.

(D) The said twenty per cent for the county roads to be distributed among the several counties in the same manner and upon the same conditions as state money aid is now distributed to said counties, except that the counties shall not be required to match the said twenty per cent or any part thereof.

(E) Said bonds to be issued in annual installments of ten million dollars per year, the beginning with the year nineteen hundred and twenty-four.

(F) The interest and sinking fund for the retirement of said bonds to be provided for by the levy of a tax not exceeding two cents per gallon on gasoline or other motor fuel and the present state mill tax for road construction or so much thereof as may be necessary.

The house attached three minor amendments which do not change the tenor of the bill and will readily be concurred in by the senate.

Richmond, Va., March 23.—The lower house yesterday afternoon concurred in the senate amendment providing for the levying of the maximum gasoline tax of three cents on July 1 and after. The bill, known as the Ozlin-Kezell-Campbell measure, at first had called for a two-cent tax in 1923, and a three-cent tax thereafter. The vote on the bill was overwhelming, 77 to 12. No opposition was voiced. The amendment is in effect a

Women Lumber Jills



Mrs. N. M. Rees (above) of Bloomfield, Col., and Mrs. Charles Eichenberger (below) of Cheyenne, Wyo., are said to be the only women in the world who own and operate lumber yards with business running into thousands of dollars yearly. They attended a convention of the Rocky Mountain Lumber Dealers' Association at Colorado Springs.

REPUBLICAN LEADERS ARE FOR HARDING

Committeemen Fear no Great Opposition From Within Party

G. O. P. BOSSES TALK

States Answer That Party is Satisfied With Administration and Predict Re-Nomination

(By United Press)

Washington, March 23.—Republican political leaders throughout the country are virtually unanimous for the renomination of President Harding, a poll of the Republican National Committee by the United Press showed today.

Every reply received in response to a request for comment on Mr. Harding's candidacy, as announced by Attorney General Daugherty, brought a prediction that the President would be re-nominated with little opposition, and likewise the committeemen made optimistic prophecies as to his chances for re-election. Many stated that delegations from their states would be solidly pledged to Mr. Harding and that the people of their states strongly favored his candidacy.

REVIEW OF SIX MONTHS' WORK GIVEN

Ordinance to Regulate Signs Adopted by Council

WILL BORROW \$55,000

Seek Establishment of Camp For Touring Automobiles—Want White Wings on Street

A review of the accomplishments of the new city council since September 1, when it took office, to March 1, 1923, is given in a report submitted by City Manager Wilder M. Rich at a meeting of the city council held yesterday afternoon.

According to the report approximately \$12,000 was collected by the office of the city manager from general licenses and automobile licenses. The report sets forth that a four year paving program is being prepared which will be submitted to the council at an early date in connection with the budget for the fiscal year ending May 31, 1924.

Plans for a purchasing department have been prepared and will be put into effect at the beginning of the fiscal year. Under this arrangement all purchases will be under the control of the city manager.

On April 1 a complete new accounting and distribution system will be installed under Capt. W. H. Sweeney, who has been appointed assistant city auditor. The present system of keeping accounts will be continued for the balance of the present fiscal year under the direction of E. F. Price, city auditor.

The regular routine work of the offices of the commissioner of revenue, treasurer, tax collector and corporation attorney has been carried on in the same manner as in the past. No changes are contemplated until the end of the present fiscal year. The installation of the new accounting system which will be made under the direction of Capt. Sweeney. A review of the street work done under the direction of City Engineer E. C. Dunn is given, including street repairs, street improvements, sidewalks, repairs to sewers, sewer improvements. It is set forth that the division of gas, with the exception of revenue collections and interest and retirement of bonds, is under the direction of R. L. Middleton, superintendent of gas. The general routine work of making and distributing coal and water gas has proceeded very satisfactorily. The gas manufactured is above the average in quality, containing an average of 650 B. T. U. The pressure maintained has also been excellent together with the quality of gas, and has kept the complaints from these sources practically to a minimum. A number of extensions of mains have been made, the cost of which has been paid out of the earnings. This class of work should be financed by a bond issue.

In connection with revenue collections it is set forth that "under the present system the finances of the gas department are handled by the clerk of gas. When the new accounting system is installed all of this work will be handled by the auditor and the treasurer."

On September, 1922, there was a temporary loan of \$15,000 outstanding and unpaid bills in excess of \$4,000. During the six months period the temporary loan has been reduced to \$5,000 and all bills have been paid to date. On March 1, 1923, there was a balance of \$1791.59 to the credit of the gas department. While this showing is excellent and is I am informed, the first time in a number of years that all bills have been paid in full—it is not

(Continued on page three)

Clock Stops With Hotel

Winchester, March 23.—When the Hotel Evans went out of business Tuesday night and closed its doors for the first time since it was opened, 26 years ago, the lobby clock ceased ticking as if stopped by magic. Repeated efforts to start it have proved unavailing and the task was given up this morning.

600 At Banquet At Cherrydale

Senator Carter Glass and Rep. Moore Address Firemen

Senator Carter Glass was the principal speaker at the banquet given last night by the Cherrydale volunteer firemen. In his speech he commended the fire-fighters for their unselfish service. Gov. E. Lee Trinkle was unable to be present. Covers were laid for 600.

The ladies who served the dinner were eulogized by Representative R. Walton Moore. Mr. Moore said he had observed with pride the steady growth of the volunteer fire department.

J. Caughan Gary, executive assistant of Virginia, praised the spirit of self sacrifice of the firemen.

Chief C. C. Donaldson, described how the department had grown from an organization with \$32 capital to an incorporated company of more than \$50,000. Former Chief E. C. Turnburke complimented the present head of the department on his organization.

Other speakers were Harry K. Green, commissioner of revenue of Arlington county; E. Wade Ball, Arlington county treasurer; Prof. Schultz, member of the faculty of American university, and the toastmaster, Fred H. Doe.

Among the guests were Thos. J. De Lashmott, chairman of the Arlington county board of supervisors; Frank L. Ball, commonwealth's attorney of Arlington county; William H. Duncan, clerk of Arlington county court; William C. Gloth, Arlington county police justice; Walter T. Oliver, State Senator; Prof. Fletcher Kemp, superintendent of Arlington county schools; Chief E. J. McDermott, of the Alexandria fire department; A. B. Eaton, chief of the Clarendon volunteer fire department, and E. J. Plarr, chief of the Ballston volunteer fire department.

SWITZERLAND AND HOLLAND PROTEST FRENCH ATTITUDE

(By United Press)

London, March 23.—Holland and Switzerland have agreed in a joint protest to the international commission on Rhine navigation against interference with goods traffic on the Rhine by the French occupation, according to the Morning Telegraph's diplomatic correspondent.

The correspondent also states the Vatican is sending an envoy to the Ruhr.

Reports from Munich, where chancellor Cuno went to make a speech last night, say the chancellor's reception was the warmest accorded any one since Hindenburg.

The Westminster Gazette's diplomatic correspondent says Great Britain and France have reached an agreement with regard to Ruhr trade which will prevent the possibility of British goods being French.

Rev. Dr. Montgomery at Christ Church Tonight

Rev. James Shera Montgomery, D. D., pastor of Cavalry Methodist Episcopal Church, Washington, will preach tonight at the Lenten services at Christ Episcopal Church at 8 o'clock. Dr. Montgomery is a preacher of great religious spirit and a man of broad vision and one of the foremost pulpits orators in the Capitol. The members of other denominations are cordially invited to be present and hear the message of this noted divine.

"KAMELIA" SISTER OF KLAN TO BE LAUNCHED ON NATION SAYS THE IMPERIAL WIZARD

Women to Work Beside Men in Building Americanization, He Says—Realizes Dream of Youth in These Klans

(By United Press)

Atlanta, March 23.—The "Kamelia," a national organization of women, founded on the lines of the Ku Klux Klan will be launched soon, Wm. Joseph Simmons, imperial emperor of the Ku Klux Klan announced here today.

The organization, which according to the announcement will function alongside the Ku Klux Klan is the result of a nationwide appeal from women, Simmons said.

Native born white, protestant women of American above the age of 18 years, will be admitted to the order, according to Simmons who declared he will issue the ritualistic work of the organization within a short time.

The new secret order of which Simmons has appointed himself the head with the title of "Em Magus," will be devoted to "a new consecration to the American home to the American government, and to the American creed of Christianity as taught by the Protestant Church," Simmons declared.

In his statement announcing the plans for the women's order Simmons reviewed the growth of the Ku Klux Klan which he founded declaring that in its successful growth he has seen the accomplishment of a dream "of his youth."

"Always in my dreams of a great renewal of Americanism there has been the contemplation of a women's organization, adhering to the same principles, committed to the same purposes and impelled by the same motives as the Ku Klux Klan," Simmons said.

Tag day and doughnut day will be observed tomorrow by the Salvation Army in order to raise the \$7600 they have started out to raise in the campaign launched a few days ago.

Assisting in the task of selling tags will be the girls of the Alexandria High School. The movement has the hearty co-operation of Superintendent of Schools, Capt. W. H. Sweeney.

Doughnuts are to be made on an electric stove in the window of the Alexandria Light and Power Company, permission having been given by E. A. Feldtkeller, superintendent of the company.

The ladies who will be in charge of making and selling the doughnuts include Mrs. T. Clifton Howard, Mrs. E. A. Feldtkeller, Mrs. Joseph Reynolds, Mrs. Richard Dennis, Mrs. Arthur K. Warfield. All are urged to buy tags and doughnuts tomorrow.

In connection with the raising of funds in the campaign a meeting was held yesterday at the chamber of commerce and a number of the teams captains submitted reports. The results thus far, however, are incomplete, although considerable territory has been worked with most satisfactory results. Other sections there are which have been lightly touched. Another meeting of team captains is scheduled to be held at 5 o'clock this afternoon, when reports will be made.

Capt. McIntyre, in charge of the Salvation Army here, says he is waiting and watching for something to happen. One person he says asked him what it was and he says he replied, "Never mind, wait till his old friends the K. K. K. comes across, and they will."

Free Speech Feature Of Communist Trial

(By United Press)

St. Joseph, Mich., March 23.—The right of free speech and free assembly today formed the basis of defense in the trial of William Z. Foster, communist, charged with violation of the Michigan syndicalist law.

Efforts were made to show the Bridgman convention which resulted in the indictment of Foster and other leaders of the communist party, did not promote acts of sabotage or violence in order to obtain political and industrial reform.

Attorneys for Foster also sought to bring out their contention that federal agents who attended the meeting as "undercover" men incited other delegates to take illegal action. Whether or not Foster will testify, was undecided.

BLAIR HOPS ON INCOME ATTORNEYS

Commissioner Takes Drastic Steps Against String Pullers

MAKE BIG HAULS

Hymn Singing Chinese Soldiers Sing Christian Tunes But Pagan Verse Forms The Theme.

(By ISAAC GREGG)

Washington, March 23.—David H. Blair, Commissioner of Internal Revenue, has taken drastic measures to prevent unscrupulous attorneys, agents, and accountants permitted to practice before the Internal Revenue Bureau from reaping a financial harvest from manufacturers and other large business concerns throughout the country by representing to them that they have a "special pull" with the Treasury Department.

The attention of Commissioner Blair has been directed to the fact that many of these persons in various sections of the industrial centers have gone to the heads of firms and explained that if they would be permitted to go over their books and accounts they would undoubtedly be able to save many thousands of dollars in rebates, annuities of taxes or credits.

Several thousand of these attorneys and agents are permitted to practice before the Internal Revenue Bureau and while the practice referred to by Commissioner Blair has not been general, there have been enough cases brought to his attention however, to warrant the action taken by the Revenue Chief.

In each of the instances brought to the attention of Mr. Blair, these attorneys have worked on a contingent basis, promising the return for their clients or charging nothing for their services.

One case in particular brought to the attention of Commissioner Blair was where one of the attorneys entered into an iron clad contingent contract with business firms for the performance of certain work before the Internal Revenue Bureau. A copy of one of these contracts made between a firm of accountants and a prominent concern in the East, was given out by Commissioner Blair today. It reads in part:

"We, the undersigned, hereby authorize the _____ or its representatives to audit our Federal Tax Returns for the years _____ for the purpose of ascertaining whether there is a possibility of recovery of taxes, either by annulment, credit, abatement or refund. In the event, in their opinion, there is a possible recovery they are to prepare the necessary papers in the premises, and we agree to co-operate with them in the carrying out of their suggestions and to furnish them with such papers in connection therewith as they may require, and to lend every assistance within our powers to aid them in the successful prosecution of any claims."

"We further agree that in the event any recovery is had, to pay them 40 per cent thereof, same to be paid within 10 days after we shall have received settlement from the Government."

"It is expressly understood and agreed that we are to pay nothing whatsoever for services in the event no recovery is made, and then only as above stated."

Light is thrown upon the so-called "Hymn-singing" Chinese soldiers of General Feng Yu-Hsiang in reports from a foreign military officer with Feng's troops actually go into battle singing Christian tunes, the Chinese words have a vastly different significance from those originally set to the music.

Feng's troops are often referred to as the hymn singing soldiers.

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WILL STORE TORPEDOES IN BIG PLANT

Employment Will be Given Twenty-Five Hands

CLOSE DOWN JULY 1

350 Knocked Out of Work—Twenty-Four Are Alexandria Mechanics and Laborers.

Out of the 325 skilled mechanics, and laborers employed at the Alexandria Naval Torpedo Station, which as heretofore stated in the Gazette will close July 1, only twenty-four reside in this city. In addition there are a few Alexandrians employed in clerical capacities. The other employees of the plant live in Washington, and the suburbs north and south of this city.

The first of the men to be let out will be a batch of fifteen in about two weeks and the remainder of the employees will be kept on the list till the first of July. Beginning July 1 it was learned today the local plant will be known as a torpedo storage station and approximately twenty-five men will be kept for this work which probably will include two clerks. The plant it was stated will remain intact.

Congress in 1918, appropriated \$2,760,000 for the construction of the Alexandria Naval Torpedo Station and this amount was used for the purchase of the land, construction of the building together with its equipment. The land on which it is constructed cost the government \$118,786. The pier cost \$50,350.

The work of constructing the plant was begun October 14, 1918, and the plant was formally turned over and completed February 5, 1920, and machinery was gradually moved in and installed and the plant has been in operation regularly ever since.

Gary Mayor's Councils Try Picking Evidence

(By United Press)

Indianapolis, March 23.—Bit by bit, attorneys for Mayor Roswell Johnson and other defendants in the Gary liquor conspiracy trials sought today to pick apart evidence presented by the government and refute it in detail. Questioning of Nathan Potts, a police sergeant listed among the defendants, was interrupted by Judge F. A. Geiger. The court obtained an admission from the witness that part of the government's strongest evidence was true. Potts confessed that defendant officials attacked Philip Ukman, star government witness and threatened him with death.